



## TRIP OFFER

# Peaks of the Balkans Self Guided

12-day independent trek

Walk ~200 km across Albania, Kosovo and Montenegro at your own pace—with lodging, meals, transfers, GPX files and round-the-clock trail support handled for you.

DURATION

12 days

DISTANCE

~200 km

LEVEL

Moderate +

FROM

€950

# More than a route. A way into the mountains.

Discover Kosovo, Montenegro and Albania on a self-guided Peaks of the Balkans journey. This long mountain trail threads remote high country, climbing toward 2,300 m on shepherd paths that once sat behind closed borders—and are now open to hikers from around the world.

The classic circuit covers roughly 200 km through the Accursed Mountains. Your itinerary typically begins in Albania, though start and finish points can be adjusted when you book.

Terrain swings from gentler valley walking to moderate+ mountain days. Solid fitness and proper trekking equipment are essential. Solo travellers, pairs and groups up to twelve are welcome; we can shorten or extend the route from about five to fourteen hiking days on request.

## BEST SEASON

June – October

## COUNTRIES

Albania · Kosovo · Montenegro

## WHAT STAYS WITH YOU

**01** Full classic route without a guide on trail

**02** GPX files plus phone support every day



# Your journey, unfolded.

## DAY 01

### Shkodër → Theth

Transfer into Theth; free afternoon in the national park.

Meet your driver in Shkodër and travel through Boga Valley—the gateway to the Albanian Alps—toward Theth. Afternoon free to explore Theth National Park. Your self-guided loop both begins and ends here; dinner is included. Small-group transfers usually leave Shkodër around 07:00 or 14:00.

Drive ~2h 10 · Dinner · Guesthouse

- Accommodation: Guesthouse
- Meals: Dinner
- Drive: ~2h 10min

## DAY 02

### Theth → Valbonë

Valbona Pass day with optional tea stop and valley descent.

Follow the trail toward Valbona Pass—a rewarding climb often chosen by first-time mountain walkers. Pause at Zefi's for hot mountain tea if you like, then continue to the col (~1,792 m) for big views of the Alps and Valbona Valley. After lunch descend on the dry riverbed road or take a bus for the final stretch. All meals included.

~16 km · 6–7h · Moderate / Challenging

- Trail ~16 km · Ascent/descent ~1,050 m / 950 m · Max ~1,759 m
- Difficulty: Moderate / Challenging
- Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

## DAY 03

### Valbonë → Çerem

Prejssllopi Pass with optional Zla Kolata side trip.

After breakfast and honeyed mountain tea, climb the zig-zag path to Prejssllopi (~2,000 m) for snowline panoramas. Crossing briefly into Montenegro, lunch can be taken at Bori Pass, a grassy saddle used by shepherds from Çerem and Vuthaj. Optional add-on: Zla Kolata (2,534 m), Montenegro's highest summit.

~14 km · 7–8h · Moderate / Challenging

- Trail ~14 km · Ascent/descent ~1,150 m / 870 m · Max ~2,040 m
- Difficulty: Moderate / Challenging
- Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

### DAY 04

#### Çerem → Dobërdol

Long forest day into a summer shepherd village.

A full day of ups and downs, mostly under forest cover, linking Çerem to Dobërdol—reachable only by mule tracks and inhabited in summer by shepherds. Climb toward the Montenegrin border, pass Balqin, and continue through the protected Gashi valley to Dobërdol's open pastures.

~16 km · 6–7h · Moderate

- Trail ~16 km · Ascent/descent ~1,025 m / 440 m · Max ~1,920 m
- Difficulty: Moderate
- Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

### DAY 05

#### Dobërdol → Milishevc

Three-border ridge and Triple Peak views.

Early start across bilberry meadows toward the ridge shared by Albania, Kosovo and Montenegro. Triple Peak (~2,266 m) looks back over the Albanian Alps already walked. Continue through alpine meadow into Milishevc, Kosovo. All meals included.

~18 km · 6–7h · Moderate

- Trail ~18 km · Ascent/descent ~950 m · Max ~2,236 m
- Difficulty: Moderate
- Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

### DAY 06

#### Milishevc → Reka e Allagës

Lumbardhi ridge, Rugova Camp, short transfer onward.

Ascend Lumbardhi ridge for wide views back toward Milishevc, then a steep descent to Rugova Camp / Restorant Gryka—good local fish if you want a longer break—before a short transfer up to Reka e Allagës.

~17 km · 6–7h · Moderate

- Trail ~17 km · Ascent/descent ~600 m / 1,430 m · Max ~2,136 m
- Difficulty: Moderate
- Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

### DAY 07

## Hajla Peak → Drelaj

Summit day to Hajla (2,403 m), then down to Drelaj.

Climb northwest from the guesthouse meadows with views of Reka e Allagës and Guri i Kuq. After roughly three hours reach Era's hut for a break, then the short, steeper push to Hajla (2,403 m). Contour the high ground for the views before a long descent into Drelaj.

~16 km · 7–8h · Moderate

- Trail ~16 km · Ascent/descent ~1,020 m / 1,320 m · Max ~2,403 m
- Difficulty: Moderate
- Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

### DAY 08

## Kuqishtë → Babino Polje

Glacial lakes and the Kosovo–Montenegro border.

Short transfer to the trailhead, then a long mountain day past springs, glacial lakes and high passes into Montenegro. After the lakes, climb toward Lugu i Shkodrës for broad alpine scenery before reaching Babino Polje.

~16 km · 7–8h · Moderate

- Trail ~16 km · Ascent/descent ~1,140 m / 1,050 m · Max ~2,276 m
- Difficulty: Moderate · Drive: ~20 min
- Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

### DAY 09

## Babino Polje → Plav

Hrid Lake swim and arrival in Plav.

Hike from Babino Polje past forest-fringed Hrid Lake—ideal for a cool swim—then continue toward Plav on a mostly wild route with Prokletije views, including the Albanian Alps in the distance. Evening free to wander Plav's old town.

~21 km · 7–8h · Moderate

- Trail ~21 km · Ascent/descent ~600 m / 1,190 m · Max ~2,236 m
- Difficulty: Moderate
- Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

### DAY 10

## Toward Vusanje via Bori

Bori Peak and Accursed Mountains panoramas.

Through beech forest and flower meadows onto Bori ridge, then a steep ramp to Bori Peak (~2,106 m) for classic Accursed Mountains views. Descend through meadow and forest into Vusanje for your last Montenegrin night. Short drive support (~25 min) as needed.

~17 km · 6–7h · Moderate

- Trail ~17 km · Ascent/descent ~740 m / 1,170 m · Max ~2,100 m
- Difficulty: Moderate · Drive: ~25 min
- Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

### DAY 11

## Karanfili viewpoints

Day hike for the finest Prokletije vistas.

Not on the official Peaks line, but often the most spectacular viewpoint day of the trip: a return hike overlooking the Karanfili massif and Albanian Alps / Prokletije. Transfer to the trailhead and back to your guesthouse (~40 min each way).

~10 km · 5–6h · Moderate

- Trail ~10 km · Ascent/descent ~1,020 m · Max ~2,056 m
- Difficulty: Moderate · Drive: ~40 min both ways
- Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

### DAY 12

## Vusanje → Theth · Shkodër

Final border hike into Theth, then transfer to Shkodër.

A long, memorable day into Prokletije National Park, crossing from Montenegro into Albania. Old military posts, bunkers and a border pyramid still mark the former closed zone. Finish in Theth where the journey began; transport continues to Shkodër (~2h 10). Optional: avoid the 4x4 section with a local transfer and ~5 km less walking from Okol.

~21 km · 6–7h · Moderate

- Trail ~21 km · Ascent/descent ~1,100 m / 1,300 m · Max ~1,435 m
- Difficulty: Moderate · Meals: Breakfast, packed lunch
- Drive to Shkodër: ~2h 10min

# What's covered. What's not.

## INCLUDED

- ✓ Transfers Shkodër–Theth and return
- ✓ Private guesthouse lodging during the trek
- ✓ All food on hiking days
- ✓ Land transport required by the itinerary
- ✓ Border permits
- ✓ GPX files and nonstop trail support

## NOT INCLUDED

- Hotels before or after the trek
- Alcoholic drinks and soft drinks
- Tips for local staff
- Luggage transport between lodges
- Transport beyond the itinerary
- National park fees
- Flights and travel insurance

## ON THE TRAIL



# Gear for the trail.

## REQUIRED

- Sturdy hiking shoes or boots
- Trekking poles
- Daypack (30 L+)
- Sun hat, sunglasses, sunscreen, swimwear
- Waterproof jacket and rain trousers
- Warm fleece or mid-layer
- Navigation: phone with GPX + offline maps / Peaks app
- Power bank
- Two 1-litre water bottles
- Personal first-aid kit and medicines
- Trail snacks

## OPTIONAL

- Headlamp or torch
- Shorts, trainers, sandals, bandana
- Camera and spare batteries
- Liner socks
- Town shoes and casual clothes
- Spare laces, luggage tags and locks
- Small knife / whistle
- Water purification tablets
- Reading material, binoculars
- Lunch box and mug

## BEFORE YOU GO

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### Travel documents

Valid passport with at least six months remaining validity.

### Money

Albania uses the lek (ALL); euros are widely accepted. Kosovo and Montenegro use the euro. Lek is typically only available inside Albania.

### ATMs

Reliable options in Tirana and Shkodër; also Gusinje and Plav on the Montenegrin side.

### Time & power

GMT+1. Electricity is 220 V / 50 Hz with two-pin round plugs.

### Visas

Most travellers (including UK, many EU, US, Canada, Australia, New Zealand) do not need a visa for Albania or Kosovo. Check current Montenegro entry rules for your nationality.

### Health

No special vaccinations are required for Kosovo, Albania or Montenegro for most visitors—bring personal medication and travel insurance.

### Support

Call or WhatsApp +383 49 601 007. Phone: Mon–Fri 08:00–20:00, Sat–Sun 14:00–17:00 (CET). Chat support runs longer into the evening.

### Reading

Useful companions: Lonely Planet Western Balkans; Robert Carver's The Accursed Mountains; Bradt guides to Kosovo and Albania; Ismail Kadare's Broken April; Edith Durham's High Albania.

# Questions before you book.

## Who is self-guided for?

Independent hikers who are comfortable navigating with GPX files and still want lodging, meals, border paperwork and phone support organised. You walk without a guide on trail, but our local team stays reachable.

## Can the itinerary be customised?

Yes. We can reshape the classic route from roughly five to fourteen hiking days, adjust start and end points, and add 4x4 links, luggage moves or airport transfers (Tirana, Podgorica and more).

## What group sizes work?

From a solo traveller or pair up to twelve people. Support stays available throughout.

## Is luggage moved for me?

Luggage transport is not in the standard self-guided price. Ask when booking if you want bag transfers added.

## How do I get help on the trail?

You receive GPX tracks plus nonstop phone and local staff support along the Peaks of the Balkans corridor. Call or WhatsApp +383 49 601 007.

## What about visas and money?

Most nationalities need no visa for Albania or Kosovo; check Montenegro separately. Euros work widely; Albanian lek is mainly for Albania itself.



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## **BALKAN PEAKS ADV**

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+383 49 601 007 · WhatsApp

Pejë, Kosovo

Offer · 12-day independent trek · From €950 · Group 2–12 travellers

Prices are for the tour only. Flights and travel insurance are separate.

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